



BHASKAR PAUL / www.indiatodayimages.com

CHABAD HOUSE DURING THE NSG ASSAULT

site Badhwar Park, Cuffe Parade, at approximately 8.30 p.m. and proceeded to unleash 60 hours of carnage. Each terrorist carried a fixed quota of AK-47s, pistols, ammunition, RDX and grenades (see box). Kasab and Abu Ismail coolly hailed a taxi (they were all carrying Indian money) and told the driver to take them to CST railway station in Urdu-accented Hindi. Kasab sat in the back while Abu Ismail sat in front and engaged the driver in conversation. While the driver's attention was

diverted, Kasab planted a RDX-filled IED beneath the driver's seat. The driver, unsuspecting, picked up another passenger and drove off. The IED, later estimated by explosive experts to be filled with RDX weighing approximately eight kg, exploded opposite the City Swan Club in Vile Parle. The explosion was of such magnitude that not only was the taxi reduced to rubble, the bodies of the taxi driver and the passenger, a lawyer, were thrown some distance away.

On reaching CST, Kasab entered

the lavatory to place another IED (later he would confess: "I connected the battery of the bomb in the bathroom. It has my name on it.") while Ismail planted an IED at the entrance. In the dim light, no one noticed them except the photographer who, alerted by the AK-47s they were armed with, took a few shots and then had to dive for cover as the two commenced firing indiscriminately and lobbed grenades at passengers waiting in the main hall. The sound of firing and grenades exploding alerted two constables posted at the station along with another pair of home guards.

The home guards were unarmed and the constables were armed with the ancient .303 rifles. They were joined by Inspector Shashank Shinde who fired at the two terrorists who ran to the staircase adjoining platform No. 1 leading to the pedestrian overbridge. They crossed over, continuing to fire and lob hand-grenades and entered the bylane between The Times of India building and the Anjuman Islam School. They first tried to flee by stealing a parked car but failed to open the

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